METHODOLOGY

they prepared to handle the pandemic.

For realistic, relevant and accurate information, MDRA evaluated colleges based on current year data and provided parameter-wise scores. In addition, the survey this year has ranked colleges in major subjects, such as Economics, History, English, Psychology, Sociology, Political Science, Physics, Chemistry, Botany, Zoology, Hindi and Sanskrit based on objective data that colleges provided.

The ranking was done in multiple steps.

- An extensive desk review of MDRA's database and secondary research was conducted to prepare a list of colleges in each stream. Only colleges offering full time, in-classroom courses and producing three batches that have graduated till 2022, were considered. In 12 streams, undergraduate courses were ranked. In Mass Communication and Social Work, post-graduate courses were evaluated.
- Experts with rich experience in their fields were consulted to frame the parameters and sub-parameters for different streams. Indicators critical for establishing best colleges were meticulously determined and their relative weights finalised. For fair comparison on year-on-year basis, weightages of parameters remained unchanged from the past two years.
- Comprehensive objective questionnaires were designed for each of the 14 streams and put up in the public domain—on the websites of INDIA TODAY and MDRA. MDRA directly contacted about 10,000 colleges fulfilling the eligibility criteria seeking objective data for verification. Attested hard and soft copies were sought and 1,715 eligible colleges—101 more than last year—submitted institutional data along with voluminous supporting documents within the deadline.
- After receiving objective data from participating colleges, MDRA verified the information and went back to the colleges if data was insufficient/incorrect or outdated
- The perceptual survey was carried out among 1,861 respondents (585 senior faculty members, 309 recruiters/professionals, 393 career accelerators and 574 final year students) across 27 cities, divided into four zones:

NORTH: Delhi, Noida, Ghaziabad, Gurugram, Faridabad, Lucknow, Kota, Amritsar, Chandigarh, Ludhiana and Roorkee

EAST: Kolkata, Bhubaneswar, Guwahati, Patna and Raipur

WEST: Mumbai, Pune, Ahmedabad, Indore, Panaji and Nagpur

SOUTH: Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Kochi and Coimbatore

- National and zonal rankings were taken from them in their respective field of experience and given 75 per cent and 25 per cent weightages respectively. They also rated the institutes on a 10-point scale on each of the five key parameters.
- While computing objective scores, aggregate data alone was not used. Hence, data were normalised on the basis of the number of students for fair comparison. The total scores arrived from objective and perception survey were added in the ratio of 60:40—for 11 professional courses—and in a ratio of 50:50 for academic courses—Arts, Science and Commerce—to get the final combined score.
- A large team of researchers, statisticians and analysts worked on this project. The MDRA core team was led by Executive Director Abhishek Agrawal and comprised Project Director Abnish Jha, Assistant Research Manager Vaibhav Gupta, Research Executive Aditya Srivastava and Senior Executive-EDP Manveer Singh.

STREAM	NO. OF PARTICIPATING COLLEGES IN					
	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018
ARTS	173	172	162	131	121	102
SCIENCE	198	187	179	145	130	108
COMMERCE	225	213	202	167	151	121
MEDICAL	57	53	55	50	50	39
DENTAL SCIENCES	61	60	59	47	47	46
ENGINEERING	278	269	249	248	242	220
ARCHITECTURE	40	42	44	31	31	25
LAW	72	62	67	49	47	47
MASS COMMUNICATION	56	47	49	40	39	25
HOTEL MANAGEMENT	76	71	69	60	51	39
BBA	201	184	179	147	132	85
BCA	171	149	146	113	97	75
FASHION DESIGN	51	49	47	35	33	28
SOCIAL WORK	56	56	52	39	36	28
TOTAL	1,715	1,614	1,559	1,302	1,207	988